

Three AI Modes

1. Interview Mode (Writing Assistant/Therapist)

- AI asks user questions
- User provides answers
- AI extracts info to Story Bible
- **Current functionality**

2. Co-writing Mode (Writer)

- User asks AI for help ("What should my protagonist's fear be?")
- AI uses Story Bible context to make creative suggestions
- AI spots patterns/connections user might not see
- **New functionality needed**

3. Auto-complete Mode ("Finish it for me")

- AI talks to itself in a loop:
 - AI-as-Therapist: "What's missing for Beat 5?"
 - AI-as-Writer: Uses Story Bible to answer creatively
 - AI-as-Therapist: Extracts answer to Story Bible
 - Repeat until all 12 beats complete
- **Most complex new functionality**

Critical Questions

About the 12 Beats

1. **What are the 12 beats?** You mentioned you'll provide the definition - are these Blake Snyder's Save the Cat beats, or a custom structure?
2. **Beat completion criteria:** How does the app know when a beat is "complete"? Does each beat require specific Story Bible fields? For example:
 - Beat 1 might need: protagonist.name, protagonist.occupation, world.setting
 - Beat 2 might need: conflict.mainConflict, protagonist.goal
3. **Beat data structure:** Are beats stored separately from Story Bible, or is Story Bible just the raw material that gets "compiled" into beats?
4. **Beat dependencies:** Do beats have to be completed in order (1→2→3...), or can they be done non-linearly?

About "Finish it for me" Mode

5. **User experience:** When user clicks "Finish it for me":
 - Do they see the AI "conversation" happening in real-time?
 - Or do they just see a progress indicator and get the final result?
 - Can they intervene/stop the process mid-way?
6. **Stopping criteria:** How does the AI know when to stop the mobius loop?
 - When all 12 beats have minimum required data?
 - When Story Bible reaches a certain completeness threshold?
 - After a maximum number of iterations?
7. **Quality control:** What are "the rules" the AI must follow? Examples:
 - Narrative coherence (protagonist's fear should relate to conflict)
 - Genre conventions (romance needs romantic tension, thriller needs urgency)
 - Character consistency (choices should align with personality)
 - Structural requirements (each beat has specific purpose)
8. **Context awareness:** In Auto-complete mode, how does AI-as-Writer make decisions?
 - Generate multiple options and pick best one?
 - Use Story Bible to infer what "fits" the story?
 - Follow genre/tone preferences from FormatConfirmationScreen?

About Story Bible Architecture

9. **Story Bible vs Beats relationship:**
 - Is Story Bible the "raw ingredients" and Beats are the "recipe"?
 - Or are Beats just a view/organization of Story Bible data?
 - Can same Story Bible data be used by multiple beats?
10. **Pattern recognition:** You mentioned AI should spot connections. Examples:
 - "Your protagonist fears abandonment AND your antagonist is their parent - interesting connection!"
 - "Your world has a rule about truth-telling AND your protagonist is a liar - that's a great conflict setup!"
 - How should AI surface these insights to the user?
11. **Creative constraints:** What prevents AI from going "off the rails" in Auto-complete mode?
 - Genre/tone constraints from user selection?
 - Existing Story Bible data is immutable (AI can only add, not change)?
 - Specific rules per beat (e.g., "Beat 3 must introduce antagonist")?

About Implementation Priority

12. **Phasing:** Should we build this in phases?
- Phase 1: Fix current Interview Mode with hybrid templates (what we planned)
 - Phase 2: Add Co-writing Mode (AI answers user questions)
 - Phase 3: Add Auto-complete Mode (AI talks to itself)
13. **MVP scope:** For "Finish it for me" v1, what's the minimum viable version?
- Just fill missing beats with AI-generated content?
 - Or full mobius loop with AI self-interviewing?

About the Master Plan Document

You mentioned "claude.md" - I created the plan at `/Users/aarongantt/.claude/plans/concurrent-swinging-perlis.md` (this is Claude Code's plan mode file).

Should I:

- **Option A:** Keep updating the plan mode file (`concurrent-swinging-perlis.md`) with all this info?
- **Option B:** Create a new master plan document in your project (e.g., `/Users/aarongantt/Desktop/STORYBEATS/docs/MASTER_PLAN.md`)?
- **Option C:** Both - plan mode file for current implementation, separate doc for overall vision?

My Recommendation

Let's tackle this in phases:

Phase 1 (Current): Hybrid template system for Interview Mode

- Get the question templates mapped to beats
- Get Story Bible capturing all the right data
- **This is the foundation everything else builds on**

Phase 2: Co-writing Mode

- AI can answer user questions using Story Bible
- AI spots patterns and connections
- User has control, AI suggests

Phase 3: Auto-complete Mode

- AI self-interviews to fill gaps
- Mobius strip magic happens
- Full 12-beat outline generated

This way we build and test incrementally rather than trying to solve everything at once.

Ready to provide the 12 beats definition and question mappings? Once I have that, I can map questions to beats and design the Story Bible → Beats relationship!

MY ANSWERS:

1. Interview mode is pretty much correct, but the AI needs to be keeping track of story potentials based on what information the user has provided up until this point.

2. Nailed it.

3. Nailed it.

Questions:

All of this is answered in the attached document. And then we are going to forego the questions for now and see if the stipulations in this 12 story beats document I've attached is enough.

5.

6. When all 12 beats have minimum required data.

7. All of the above for these. The document attached has other rules and stipulations.

8. Combination of using the story bible to infer and then following genre/tone conventions.

9. Yes, Bible is the raw ingredients, beats are the recipe. It's a database for the AI on the backend, not for the user. The story bible is the central database from which ALL beats are derived.

10. These are great examples, and that's a good follow up questions... I do not know. Maybe it's random, maybe it should alert the user to an idea that the AI has had (a pattern it sees). What are some options with this? I'd love to hear some ideas.

11. All of the above; auto-complete is guided by the rules of the 12-beats and the information in the story bible, so as it's auto-completing, it's narrowing its own options down with each question it answers to itself.

12. We are building all of this for the MVP

13. Full mobius loop.

Option C